

The following variables are used in the count analysis and will be contained in the file “data for count models.dta” generated by the file “table 2.do”

state: The name of the state

staten: The number for the state, 1-50 in alphabetical order

year: The year the survey was conducted

quarter: The quarter the survey was conducted

quarter_year: A counter for the quarter year; the variable is the year added to the quarter divided by 10 such that it is year.quarter

ticker: A counter of the number of quarters that have elapsed since the start of 1980

electionquarter: A dummy variable for the regularly scheduled Governor Election Quarter, 1 if it happened in that quarter and 0 otherwise

margin_last_pres_election: The Margin in the Last Presidential Election, measured as the absolute value between the top-two vote getters in the last presidential election in the state such that high values represent uncompetitive races. Election totals are measured as percentages on a 0-100 scale and election data comes from the state-by-state breakdown of results published on Wikipedia for each presidential election.

margin_last_gov_election: Margin Last Governor Election, measured as the absolute value between the top-two vote getters in the last gubernatorial election in the state such that high values represent uncompetitive races. Percentages for each candidates are measured on a 0-100 scale. Data on governor races comes from Wikipedia.

margin_next_pres_election: Margin in the Next Presidential Election, measured as the absolute value between the top-two vote getters in the next presidential election in the state such that high values represent uncompetitive races. Election totals are measured as percentages on a 0-100 scale and election data comes from the state-by-state breakdown of results published on Wikipedia.

margin_next_gov_election: Margin in Next Governor Election, measured as the absolute value between the top-two vote getters in the last presidential election in the state such that high values represent uncompetitive races. Coded as missing for states where the next gubernatorial election was scheduled for after the 2020 data collection window. Percentages for each candidates are measured on a 0-100 scale. Data on governor races comes from Wikipedia.

ln_population: Ln(Population): the natural log of the population of the state in that year, with the data on population taken from the Bureau of Economic Analysis

pres_election_quarter: A dummy variable for the Presidential Election Quarter, 1 if an election for president happened that quarter and 0 otherwise

lead_pres_election_quarter: A dummy variable for the Quarter Before the President Election, takes the value of 1 in the third quarter of a presidential election year and 0 otherwise

lead2_pres_election_quarter: A dummy variable for being Two Quarters Before the President Election, takes the value of 1 in the second quarter of a presidential election year and 0 otherwise

lead3_pres_election_quarter: A dummy variable for being Three Quarters Before the President Election, takes the value of 1 in the first quarter of a presidential election year and 0 otherwise

lead_gov_election_quarter: A dummy variable for the Quarter Before a Governor Election, takes the value of 1 in the third quarter of the gubernatorial election year and 0 otherwise

lead2_gov_election_quarter: A dummy variable for being Two Quarters Before a Governor Election, takes the value of 1 in the second quarter of the gubernatorial election year and 0 otherwise

lead3_gov_election_quarter: A dummy variable for being Three Quarters Before Governor Election, takes the value of 1 in the first quarter of the gubernatorial election year and 0 otherwise

yrs1986_1990: A dummy variable for the survey being conducted between the Years 1986-1990, 0= not in that period, 1= is included in the period

yrs1991_1995: A dummy variable for the survey being conducted between the Years 1991-1995, 0= not in that period, 1= is included in the period

yrs1996_2000: A dummy variable for the survey being conducted between the Years 1996-2000, 0= not in that period, 1= is included in the period

yrs2001_2005: A dummy variable for the survey being conducted between the Years 2001-2005, 0= not in that period, 1= is included in the period

yrs2006_2010: A dummy variable for the survey being conducted between the Years 2006-2010, 0= not in that period, 1= is included in the period.

yrs2011_2015: A dummy variable for the survey being conducted between the Years 2011-2015, 0= not in that period, 1= is included in the period.

yrs2016_2020: A dummy variable for the survey being conducted between the Years 2016-2020, 0= not in that period, 1= is included in the period.

special_election: A dummy variable for the quarter where a special election for governor (either a recall or to replace a deceased/impeached governor was held), labeled as the "Special Election Quarter." Takes the value of 1 if the election was held that quarter and 0 otherwise

lead_special_election: A dummy variable for being the Quarter Before a Special Election. Takes

the value of 1 if the election was held that next quarter and 0 otherwise

lead2_special_election: A dummy variable for being Two Quarters Before a Special Election. Takes the value of 1 if the election was held in two quarters and 0 otherwise

The following variable will be generated by the do-file "table 2.do"

surveyn: The number of surveys conducted in that quarter; the dependent variable in the analysis. This variable is generated by counting the number of surveys in each quarter in "Approval data for SEAD" v1.dta"